

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

and sorrows - the one to buoy us up from becoming depressed, the other to check us in our inordinate esteem of self and of worldly advantages.

Is this not exactly the conclusion to which you come in your letter

exclaims that faith and that Christian philosophy; "How vain and how trivial /in ip̄sis "How vain!" are the joys alike and the sorrows of this really 'momentary existence' that worldlings are so inclined to worship as LIFE! Vain they are indeed

Vain indeed in themselves, when we think of eternity, must seem anything that passes away; and only inasmuch as they buoy us up from depression or check us in our inordinate esteem of self and the world can they be considered really important. In this sense and considering our condition as pilgrims to ETERNITY THEY would seem to be a sort of salvation not only important but positively necessary. We hardly need go further than your own letter and recent experience, to corroborate this philosophy." . . . Her death/has brot out to me the utter emptiness of life except for something too fine to express in words. "Our food, our clothing, our home, our material things mean so little in the final analisis. "I am praying for more of the faith that she had; more of that which, I cannot define, other than a sup̄rime confidence in God and a firm belief in a hereafter. "She had so much of it. "I have so little. "Sometimes I think, that first the death of little John and now her death are but signs, or a writing on the wall, a sort of warning to me. . . . "Now I want to rise up above material things, to get a better picture of life, a truer sense of values."

(unfinished)